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10 Facts About AI in Professional Sports

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Fact 01

\$23B

Market Size by 2033

The global sports analytics market is projected to grow from \$5.68 billion in 2025 to over \$23 billion by 2033.

Source: Grand View Research, 2025

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Fact 02

32%

Most Used AI Method

Neural networks are the most widely used AI technique in sports analytics research.

Source: Pietraszewski et al., 2025

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Fact 03

5

Types of Data Used

AI models rely on performance stats, GPS tracking, biometric data, video analysis, and historical performance to evaluate athletes.

Source: Pietraszewski et al., 2025

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Fact 04

GPS

Real-Time Tracking

GPS tracking systems measure player speed, distance traveled, and positioning during games in real time

Source: Hammes et al., 2026

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Fact 05

Bias

A Real Risk

When AI models are trained on incomplete or biased data, they may reinforce existing inequalities in athlete evaluation.

Source: Hammes et al., 2026

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Fact 06

+20%

Performance Improvement

AI-assisted training can improve athletic performance by **up to 20%**, outperforming traditional training methods

Source: PubMed Central (PMC), 2025

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Fact 07

Smarter Scouting

Data-Driven Decisions

AI helps teams evaluate players more accurately by using **data-driven insights** to support **recruiting, drafting** and **roster decisions**.

Source: ScienceDirect, 2025

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Fact 08

€704M

The Cost of Injuries

Injury costs exceed **€704 Million** in one season for top European football leagues — showing why teams are turning to **AI to predict and prevent injuries**

Source: PubMed Central (PMC), 2024

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Fact 09

1960s

Decades of Evolution

AI in sports dates back to the **1960s** — evolving from simple mathematical models to **advanced systems** used for player evaluation, strategy, and performance analysis.

Source: PubMed Central (PMC), 2024

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Fact 10

Real-Time AI Game-Time Decisions

AI uses live data to provide **real-time tactical adjustments**, helping coaches make smarter decisions. Teams like the **Toronto Raptors** and **Liverpool FC** already use AI to optimize in-game strategy

Source: PubMed Central (PMC), 2024

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